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Southern Water.

1 message

chrisharris8639@gmail.com <chrisharris8639@gmail.com> 16 February 2026 at 20:44
To: Nick Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com>

Nick,

I have been trying to make sense of the latest Southern Water horror story and to say how sorry Wendy and I are that you have had to undergo the experience.

This is my best recall of the events of yesterday the 15th of February.

- At or about 1030 our water supply was cut off and I called Southern Water to report it. They advised me that an engineer would call to investigate within two hours.
- At or about 1300 the engineer (Alex?) called and together we searched for the stopcock controlling our three cottages. I had thought this was in the hedge bordering the road to the pumping station but, it was, in fact, South of that adjacent to the drain in the road.
- I think he told me that the stopcock was off which, of course, made no sense as there was no-one present at the time the supply ceased to turn it off.
- Louisa confirms that the house was dry when she called earlier and I'm pretty sure there was no sign of water outside your front door at 1300.
- The repair team arrived at or about1600 and proceeded to dig a hole outside Maggie's wall and opposite the road to the pumping station which is where Alex had apparently detected the possibility of a leak.
- Later I was told that the stopcock might have been faulty and was causing the leak.
- At or about 1600, when talking to the repair team I noticed water standing outside your front door and assumed that its origin was outside the house. I told them they must have caused this and would have to clear it up. It was not possible at this time to see inside the house and I was reluctant to call Louisa if that was the extent of the problem.
- When I did call Louisa and she came with the key it became apparent that the leak was inside the house and Southern Water, true to form, blamed your builder for not capping a pipe properly. This, they claim, burst and caused the flood.

So. It appears that the Southern Water theory is that a surge in pressure caused the cap to fail and water that should have fed our taps instead flooded the house. This is inconsistent with the claim that the stopcock was in an off position at 1300 or that it was faulty. There was no sign of any flooding at 1300.

My theory, for which I have little positive proof, is that the stopcock failed at 1030 and caused the water cut off. Alex, when investigating manipulated the stopcock in such a way that it caused the cap to burst and the flood which manifested itself outside the front door at 1600.

Since writing that last sentence I have spoken to Jason and his plumber and we are agreed that the above is the likeliest scenario. The plumber suggested that at some point the pressure at the stopcock was reduced (this ties in with my experience that the water pressure did indeed drop from above 5bar to 4 some time last year) and that Alex, in examining the stopcock thought it was off and opened it up causing a surge of pressure which burst the connection in the house. I asked the plumber how long he thought it would take for the house to flood to six inches and he thought about three hours. This ties in with the 1300 manipulation of the stopcock and my noticing water outside the front door at 1600. The only thing against this is the cutoff of supply at 1030. That I can only put down to a failure of the valve on the stopcock which Alex told me was faulty.

I hope this is of some help – our collective fury at Southern Water's ability to blame anyone but themselves continues unabated.

Chris

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